Rafael Campello de Alcantara

Curriculum Vitae

The University of Texas at Austin
rafael.campellodealcantara@mccombs.utexas.edu
https://rafaelcalcantara.github.io/

Research experience

Postdoctoral fellow 2024-present

The University of Texas at Austin
McCombs School of Business

Visiting scholar 2023

School of Mathematical and Statistical Sciences, Arizona State University
Sponsor: P. Richard Hahn

Research Assistant 2022

Insper, São Paulo, Brazil
Supervisors: Naércio Aquino Menezes Filho, Camila de Freitas Souza Campos

Education

PhD in Business Economics 2020-2024

Insper - Institute of Education and Research, São Paulo, Brazil
Dissertation: A Constrained BART Model For Identifying Heterogeneous Treatment Effects In Regression Discontinuity Designs
Advisor: Hedibert Freitas Lopes

MSc in Applied Economics 2018-2020

Universidade de São Paulo, USP, São Paulo, Brazil
Thesis: Estimation of the R&D Elasticity in Brazil: An Unobserved Common Factor Approach
Advisor: Sérgio Kannebley Júnior

BA in Economics 2013-2017

Universidade de Brasília, UnB, Brasília, Brazil
Advisor: Andrea Felippe Cabello

Publications

1. A Bayesian Additive Regression Tree Model for Learning Conditional Average Treatment Effects in Regression Discontinuity Designs
with P. Richard Hahn and Hedibert F. Lopes
Accepted for publication, Observational Studies

2. R&D Elasticity in Brazilian Manufacturing and Spillovers - An Unobserved Common Factors Approach
with Sergio Kannebley Jr.
Brazilian Journal of Applied Economics, 2024

Preprints

3. Modified BART for Learning Heterogeneous Effects in Regression Discontinuity Designs
with Meijia Wang, P. Richard Hahn and Hedibert F. Lopes

Work in progress

4. Searching for Parallel Trends: Discovering Diff-in-Diff Estimators,
with Andrew Herren, Palak Jain, P. Richard Hahn, Jared Murray

5. Statistical Aspects of SHAP: Functional ANOVA for Model Interpretation
with Andrew Herren, P. Richard Hahn

Seminar and conference presentations

Searching for parallel trends: Discovering diff-in-diff estimators (with Andrew Herren, Palak Jain, P. Richard Hahn, Jared Murray), European Seminar on Bayesian Econometrics (ESOBE), August 2026

Learning Conditional Average Treatment Effects in Regression Discontinuity Designs using Bayesian Additive Regression Trees (with P. Richard Hahn, Hedibert F. Lopes), International Society for Bayesian Analysis (ISBA) World Meeting, July 2026

A Constrained BART Model for Identifying Heterogeneous Treatment Effects in regression discontinuity design (with Meijia Wang, P. Richard Hahn, Hedibert F. Lopes), LACEA-LAMES Annual Meeting, November 2024

A Modified BART Prior for Regression Discontinuity Designs (with Meijia Wang, P. Richard Hahn, Hedibert F. Lopes), NBER-NSF Seminar on Bayesian Inference in Econometrics and Statistics, August 2023

Bayesian Additive Regression Trees For Regression Discontinuity Designs (with Hedibert F. Lopes), 44th Meeting of the Brazilian Econometric Society, December 2022

Teaching

Insper, São Paulo, Brazil 2023
Teaching assistant of Bayesian Econometrics
Professor: Hedibert Freitas Lopes

Insper, São Paulo, Brazil 2022
Teaching assistant of Bayesian Learning
Professor: Hedibert Freitas Lopes

Refereeing

Journal of Applied Econometrics, Journal of Computational and Graphical Statistics, Applied Economics Letters, Statistics in Medicine

Technical skills

Advanced R, intermediate Stata, basic SQL, basic Python

Language

Native Portuguese, fluent English